

Finance Committee Meeting – Westhampton Town Hall
May 4th, 2026
6:00pm

Present: Tad Weiss (Chair), Jennifer Milikowsky (taking notes), Jeremy Durrin, Scott Stanton, Jon Albitz, Maureen Dempsey, Steve Holt

Also Present: Doug Finn and Police Chief Dave White

Weiss called the meeting to order at 6:03pm

Review of Minutes

Stanton motioned to accept April 29th minutes with formatting edits. Albitz Seconded.

VOTE TO ACCEPT: 7-0-0

Review of Warrant Articles for Town Meeting

Article 2:

Proposal of Revolving Fund

Presentation around its purpose and source of funding. Discussion of implications to the budget in FY27 and beyond.

Weiss Motioned to recommend Article 2. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO RECOMMEND: 7-0-0

Article 3:

Background information given around the leasing of the capped landfill for solar. Brief discussion of the financial implications of it.

Stanton Motioned to recommend Article 3. Durrin Seconded.

VOTE TO RECOMMEND: 7-0-0

Article 5:

No discussion necessary. Everyone was aware from previous conversations as to the purpose and benefits of town Revolving Funds.

Durrin Motioned to recommend Article 5. Stanton Seconded.

VOTE TO RECOMMEND: 7-0-0

Article 6:

No discussion necessary. Everyone agreed we went line by line through the proposed budget last week and felt comfortable proceeding with no changes.

Durrin Motioned to recommend Article 6. Albitz Seconded.

VOTE TO RECOMMEND: 6-0-1

Article 7:

Discussion around the appropriate timing of making a recommendation on the Hampshire Regional High School Budget. Points discussed included:

- The 9.5% year over year overall HRHS budget increase compared to negative year-over-year deltas for all town departments.
- No other department will have clarity after Town Meeting
- The need for HRHS to know whether their budget is approved in order to make decisions for next FY
- Could the override impact the HRHS budget? Could an override ever impact the HRHS budget?
- How do we recommend 21.3% of our budget without knowing how much revenue we have to balance our expenses against?

Durrin Motioned to recommend taking no action. Holt Seconded.

VOTE TO TAKE NO ACTION: 7-0-0

Brief discussion about the capital plan and Article 8. Consensus that if the police cruiser were funded at Town Meeting, Stabilization is the appropriate funding source. Discussion with Police Chief about need to better understand the cost of a new police cruiser, the operating costs of current police cruiser and the implications of delaying its replacement.

Articles 8, 9, 10, 11:

Stanton motioned to recommend taking no action on Articles 8, 9, 10, 11. Albitz Seconded.

VOTE TO TAKE NO ACTION: 7-0-0

Durrin motioned to adjourn. Stanton seconded.

VOTE TO ADJOURN: 7-0-0 (6:52)